Reading Comprehension: Non-Fiction

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion: Extract: 'The Amazon rainforest produces about 20% of the world's oxygen, and in my view, it is the most precious place on Earth.' Which part of this sentence is an opinion?

Answer: 'it is the most precious place on Earth' is an opinion (signalled by 'in my view'); the statement about 20% of oxygen is a fact.

Purpose & Tone: Extract: 'Save water, save the planet — every drop counts! Turn off the tap while you brush your teeth.' What is the purpose and tone of this extract?

Answer: Purpose: persuasive, encouraging readers to save water; Tone: urgent and encouraging.

Persuasive Techniques: Extract: 'Don't miss out — this incredible offer won't last!' Identify one persuasive technique used here.

Answer: Exaggeration and urgency ('incredible offer', 'won't last') are used to create a sense of urgency and encourage quick action.

Retrieval & Fact vs Opinion (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa, standing at 5,895 metres above sea level. It is a dormant volcano located in Tanzania and attracts thousands of climbers every year.' According to the extract, how tall is Mount Kilimanjaro?
2. In the Kilimanjaro extract, in which country is the mountain located?
3. Which of the following sentences would be a FACT rather than an opinion if added to the Kilimanjaro extract? A) 'Mount Kilimanjaro is the tallest mountain in Africa.' B) 'Climbing Kilimanjaro is the most wonderful experience in the world.' C) 'Kilimanjaro is more beautiful than any other mountain.' D) 'Everyone should climb Kilimanjaro at least once.' E) 'Kilimanjaro is the best holiday destination.'
4. Extract: 'Recycling one aluminium can saves enough energy to power a television for three hours. Despite this, nearly half of all cans are still thrown away instead of recycled — which, in my opinion, is a shocking waste.' According to the extract, how much energy does recycling one can save?
5. In the recycling extract, what proportion of cans are still thrown away instead of recycled?
6. In the recycling extract, which phrase signals that a statement is the writer's opinion rather than a fact? A) 'in my opinion' B) 'one aluminium can' C) 'three hours' D) 'nearly half' E) 'thrown away'
7. Extract: 'Honeybees are responsible for pollinating around one third of the food crops humans eat. A single bee colony can contain up to 60,000 bees during peak summer months.' According to the extract, what proportion of food crops do honeybees help to pollinate?
8. In the bee extract, how many bees can a single colony contain during peak summer?
9. Select ALL that apply, based on the bee extract: which statements are FACTS stated in the extract (not opinions)? A) Honeybees pollinate around a third of food crops. B) A colony can contain up to 60,000 bees in summer. C) Bees are the most important insect on Earth. D) Honeybees are the hardest-working insects. E) Peak summer months see the largest colony sizes.

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10. Extract: 'The Great Wall of China stretches for over 21,000 kilometres when all its branches and sections are included. Construction began over 2,000 years ago and continued across several dynasties.' According to the extract, how long is the Great Wall including all its branches?

11. In the Great Wall extract, when did construction begin?

12. Which of these would be considered an OPINION if added to the Great Wall extract? A) 'The Great Wall is the most impressive structure ever built.' B) 'The wall stretches over 21,000 kilometres.' C) 'Construction began over 2,000 years ago.' D) 'Several dynasties contributed to its construction.' E) 'The wall is located in China.'

13. Extract: 'Experts recommend that children aged 9 to 11 get between 9 and 11 hours of sleep each night. Lack of sleep can affect concentration, mood, and memory.' According to the extract, how many hours of sleep is recommended for children aged 9 to 11?

14. In the sleep extract, name two things, according to the extract, that can be affected by lack of sleep.

15. Is the statement 'children aged 9 to 11 get between 9 and 11 hours of sleep each night' a fact or an opinion, as it is presented in the extract? A) A fact, since it is based on expert recommendations B) An opinion, since it is just the writer's feeling C) Neither a fact nor an opinion D) A fact, but only because it mentions a number E) An opinion, because it mentions children

Purpose, Audience & Main Idea (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'Is your child struggling to find clean, ironed clothes every morning? Our new wrinkle-free school uniform range means no more ironing, no more stress — just a smarter start to the school day!' What is the main purpose of this extract?

2. Who is the school uniform extract most likely aimed at? A) Parents of school-age children B) Retired people C) Toddlers D) Teachers only E) Scientists

3. Describe the tone of the school uniform extract.

4. Extract: 'The Natural History Gallery is open daily from 10 am to 5 pm. Visitors can explore exhibits on dinosaurs, space, and the human body across three floors.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

5. Describe the tone of the museum extract.

6. What is the main idea of the museum extract? A) It gives practical information about visiting the Natural History Gallery B) It argues that dinosaurs are extinct C) It persuades readers to become scientists D) It criticises the museum's opening hours E) It describes a visitor's personal opinion of the gallery

7. Extract: 'Some people believe homework helps pupils practise what they have learned at school. Others argue it takes up time that could be spent on hobbies, sport or rest. Both views have some merit.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

8. What is the tone of the homework extract? A) Balanced and even-handed B) Angrily one-sided C) Mocking D) Purely celebratory E) Frightened

9. What is the main idea of the homework extract?

10. Extract: 'Every day, children just like yours go without clean drinking water. A small donation from you could provide a family with safe water for an entire month. Please, give what you can today.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

11. Who is the water charity extract most likely aimed at?

12. Select ALL that apply, based on the water charity extract: which techniques or features are used to achieve its purpose? A) Direct address to the reader ('yours', 'you') B) An emotive comparison ('children just like yours') C) A direct request for action ('Please, give what you can today') D) A table of statistics E) A joke to lighten the mood

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13. Extract: 'First, preheat the oven to 180°C. Then mix the flour and sugar in a large bowl before adding the eggs one at a time, stirring continuously.' What is the main purpose of this extract?

14. Describe the tone of the recipe extract.

15. What text structure does the recipe extract use? A) Chronological/sequential steps B) Comparison of two ideas C) Cause and effect only D) A persuasive argument E) A personal anecdote

Persuasive Techniques & Inference (15 questions)

1. Extract: 'How much longer can we ignore the plastic choking our oceans? Every year, millions of tonnes of plastic waste are dumped into the sea, killing countless innocent creatures. Isn't it time we acted?' Identify ONE rhetorical question used in this extract.

2. In the plastic extract, what is the effect of using rhetorical questions? A) They make the reader stop and consider the issue, implying there is an obvious answer B) They provide statistical proof C) They offer a balanced counter-argument D) They are purely decorative with no persuasive effect E) They confuse the reader intentionally

3. In the plastic extract, identify an example of emotive language and explain its effect.

4. Extract: 'Nine out of ten dentists recommend this toothpaste. In clinical trials, 95% of users reported stronger, healthier teeth within just two weeks.' Identify the statistic used in this extract to support the claim about dentists.

5. In the toothpaste extract, why might an advertiser choose to include statistics like '95% of users' rather than simply saying 'most users'? A) Precise numbers sound more scientific and convincing, increasing the reader's trust B) Numbers are required by law in all adverts C) Numbers make the advert shorter D) Numbers are harder to understand so they confuse the reader into buying E) Statistics have no effect on persuasion

6. In the toothpaste extract, what persuasive technique, other than statistics, is used in the phrase 'nine out of ten dentists recommend'?

7. Extract: 'This is the fastest, strongest and most reliable phone ever made. It will change the way you live, work and play — forever.' Identify the 'rule of three' used in this extract.

8. Select ALL that apply, based on the phone extract: which persuasive techniques are used? A) Rule of three B) Exaggeration/hyperbole ('change the way you live... forever') C) A rhetorical question D) A direct quotation from a scientist E) Repetition of a list of three verbs

9. Given that the phone extract claims the phone will 'change the way you live, work and play — forever', what should a careful reader be aware of? A) This is an exaggerated claim typical of advertising and may not be literally true B) This claim has been proven in independent scientific trials C) This is a neutral, factual statement D) This claim applies only to older phones E) This claim is understated, not exaggerated

10. Extract: 'Residents are furious. Our local library — a lifeline for children, job-seekers and the elderly alike — faces closure within months. How can the council justify abandoning our community like this?' Identify an example of emotive language in this extract.

11. In the library extract, identify the rhetorical question used.

12. The library extract lists 'children, job-seekers and the elderly alike' as those affected. What is the likely purpose of listing several different groups? A) To show the closure would affect almost everyone in the community, broadening sympathy for the cause B) To prove that only elderly people use the library C) To show that the library is rarely used D) To argue that children should not use libraries E) To list people who support the closure

13. Extract: 'Why pay more for less? Our rival's cereal bar has 30% more sugar and costs 20p more per box — isn't it time you made the smarter choice?' Identify the rhetorical question(s) used in this extract.

14. In the cereal bar extract, explain how the comparison with the rival product ('30% more sugar and costs 20p more') is used to persuade the reader, and what assumption the advert wants you to make.

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15. In the cereal bar extract, explain what persuasive technique is shown by the direct address 'isn't it time you made the smarter choice?'

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